INCH-POUND

MIL-B-44256B
2 December 1988
SUPERSEDING
MIL-B-44256A
21 March 1988

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

BLUEBERRY DESSERT, TRAY PACK

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers blueberry dessert in tray pack cans for use by the Department of Defense as a component of operational rations.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. The following specifications, standards, and handbooks form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DODISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation (see 6.1).

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

TT-C-495 - Coatings, Exterior, for Tinned Food Cans
PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, Natick, MA 01760-5014 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 8940

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T01:00Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

MILITARY

MIL-C-44340 - Can, Tray Pack
MIL-L-1497 - Labeling of Metal Cans for Subsistence items
MIL-L-35078 - Loads, Unit: Preparation of Semiperishable Items; Clothing, Personal Equipment and Equipage; General Specifications For

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-900 - Bacterial Standards for Starches, Flours, Cereals, Alimentary Pastes, Dry Milks and Sugars used in the Preparation of Thermostabilized Foods for the Armed Forces

(Unless otherwise indicated, copies of federal and military specifications, standards, and handbooks are available from the Naval Publications and Forms Center, (ATTN: NPODS), 5801 Tabor Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19120-5099.)

2.1.2 Other Government documents, drawings, and publications. The following other Government documents, drawings, and publications form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues are those cited in the solicitation.

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder (21 CFR PARTS 1-199)

(Copies are available from the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF AGRICULTURE (USDA)

U.S. Standards for Grades of Frozen Blueberries

(Copies are available from the Director, Fruit and Vegetable Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Room 2077, South Building, P.O. Box 96456, Washington, DC 20090-6456.)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T01:00Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

U.S. Standards for Condition of Food Containers

(Copies are available from the Chairman, Condition of Food Container Committee, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Room 0610, South Building, P.O. Box 96456, Washington, DC 20090-6456.)

ENVIRONMENTAL PROTECTION AGENCY (EPA)

National Primary Drinking Water Regulations

(Copies are available from the Office of Drinking Water, Environmental Protection Agency, WH550, 401 M Street, S.W., Washington, DC 20460.)

2.2 Non-Government publications. The following documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DOD adopted shall be those listed in the issue of the DODISS specified in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DODISS are the issues of the documents cited in the solicitation (see 6.1).

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS (ASTM)

D 3330 - Peel Adhesion of Pressure-sensitive Tape

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

ASSOCIATION OF OFFICIAL ANALYTICAL CHEMISTS (AOAC)

Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, 1111 North 19th Street, Suite 210, Arlington, VA 22209.)

AMERICAN ASSOCIATION OF CEREAL CHEMISTS (AACC)

Approved Methods of the American Association of Cereal Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Association of Cereal Chemists, 3340 Pilot Knob Road, St. Paul, MN 55121.)

NATIONAL ACADEMY OF SCIENCE

Food Chemicals Codex

(Application for copies should be addressed to the National Academy Press, 2101 Constitution Avenue, N.W., Washington, DC 20418.)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T01:00Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

(Nongovernment standards and other publications are normally available from the organizations that prepare or which distribute the documents. These documents may also be available in or through libraries or other informational services.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document takes precedence. Nothing in this document, however, supersedes applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified (see 6.1), a sample shall be subjected to the first article inspection (see 6.3) in accordance with 4.4.

3.2 Ingredients. All ingredients shall be clean, sound, wholesome, and free from foreign material, evidence of rodent or insect infestation, extraneous material, off-odors, off-flavors, and off-colors.

3.2.1 Blueberries, fresh. The fresh blueberries shall be of the native or wild type (Maine lowbush, Vaccinium angustifolium) or may be cultivated and be suitable for canning. Cultivated blueberries shall be in the size range of 400 count or more per pound. Fresh wild or cultivated blueberries shall not be over-ripe and shall be free of decay and practically free of defects.

3.2.2 Blueberries, frozen. The frozen blueberries shall be of the native or wild type or may be cultivated and shall be U.S. Grade A of the U.S. Standards for Grades of Frozen Blueberries. Cultivated blueberries shall be in the size range of 400 count or more per pound. Frozen wild or cultivated blueberries shall be of the latest seasons crop.

3.2.3 Water. Water is used for formulation, blanching, and washing shall conform to the National Primary Drinking Water Regulations.

3.2.4 Sugar, white, granulated. Sugar shall be white, refined, granulated cane or beet or a blend of both and shall comply with MIL-STD-900.

3.2.5 Starch, waxy maize, modified. The starch shall be white, odorless, finely pulverized, modified, waxy maize starch for use in thermoprocessed foods. The modified starch shall demonstrate initial viscosity development in the temperature range of 140° to 170°F and a typical viscosity (be fully hydrated) at common retort temperatures. The starch shall resist breakdown at low pH, under sheer stress, and under conditions of cold storage. The starch shall be bland with essentially no cereal or starch taste and shall comply with MIL-STD-900.

3.2.6 Juice, lemon. Lemon juice shall be prepared from the unfermented juice, obtained from fresh sound mature and thoroughly cleaned fruit of one or more of the high acid varieties of the species Citrus limon (limonia). Such lemon juice may be canned or frozen, single strength or concentrated.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T01:00Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.2.7 Salt. Salt shall be noniodized, white, refined sodium chloride with or without anticaking agents and shall comply with the purity standards for sodium chloride as described in the Food Chemicals Codex.

3.3 Preparation and processing. Processing shall be on a continuous basis.

3.3.1 Frozen blueberry preparation. Blueberries shall be used in the frozen state.

3.3.2 Fresh blueberry preparation. Blueberries shall be cleaned to remove leaves, sticks, stems, and other foreign material. The berries shall be washed and thoroughly drained prior to further preparation.

3.3.3 Preparation of the dessert. The blueberry dessert shall be formulated and prepared as follows:

Ingredients	Percent by weight
Blueberries	60.0
Water	20.2
Sugar	15.2
Starch, modified	3.0
Juice, lemon, single strength 1/	1.5
Salt 2/	0.1

1/ The total amount of lemon juice shall be adjusted as necessary to assure compliance with the finished product pH requirements.

2/ The total amount of salt shall be adjusted as necessary, to assure compliance with the finished product salt requirements.

a. Approximately 80 percent of the water and the salt, sugar and lemon juice shall be mixed and heated until the sugar is completely dissolved.

b. A thin slurry of the remaining water and the starch shall be prepared and added to the above mixture with continuous agitation.

c. When a hot fill method is to be used (see 3.4.1), the blueberries shall be gradually added to the mixture and the mixture shall be heated to 180° to 190°F with continuous but gentle agitation.

d. When a thermoprocessing method is to be used (see 3.4.2), the blueberries shall be gradually added to the mixture and the mixture shall be heated to 140° to 160°F with continuous but gentle agitation.

e. The volume of the final mixture shall be adjusted with water to compensate for evaporation loss during heating and holding.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T01:00Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

f. The cooked product shall be filled into tray pack cans within 1 hour after cooking. The temperature of the prepared product shall be maintained at not less than 190°F until filling into the cans or at not less than 150°F if the cans are to be thermoprocessed after filling and sealing (see 3.4.2).

3.4 Tray pack hot filling and thermostabilizing. Each tray pack can (see 5.1.1) shall be filled with product such as to conform to the finished product requirements and to the method specified in either 3.4.1 or 3.4.2

3.4.1 Hot fill method.

a. The temperature of the product at the time of filling shall be in the temperature range of 190°F to 200°F.

b. Each can shall be hermetically sealed at a product temperature of not less than 180°F so as to assure compliance with the finished product requirement (see 3.5).

c. The cans shall be inverted immediately after sealing, held for 5 minutes and then rapidly cooled to 100°F or less.

3.4.2 Thermoprocessing method.

a. Each can shall be hermetically sealed under a vacuum established by a processing authority and specified in the scheduled process so as to assure compliance with the finished product requirement (see 3.5).

b. The filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be thermostabilized by retorting at 220°F or below to an internal product temperature of 185° to 195°F. The product shall then be immediately cooled to 100°F or less.

c. The filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be in the retort process within 2 hours after product preparation.

3.5 Finished product requirements. The finished product shall comply with the following requirements.

a. There shall be no foreign material such as, but not limited to, dirt, insects, insect parts, hair, wood, glass, or metal.

b. There shall be no foreign odor or flavor such as, but not limited to, burnt, scorched, stale, sour, rancid, or moldy.

c. There shall be no color foreign to the product.

d. The average net weight shall be not less than 106 ounces.

e. No individual can shall contain less than 104 ounces.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T01:00Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

f. The salt content shall be not greater than 0.30 percent nor less than 0.10 percent.

g. Blueberries shall not be hard, fibrous, tough, or mushy.

h. The sauce shall not be lumpy and shall have a glossy, smooth appearance.

i. There shall be no evidence of syneresis.

j. The pH shall be in the range of 3.2 to 3.8 inclusive.

k. The product shall show no evidence of excessive heating (materially darkened or scorched).

l. The viscosity of the sauce shall be not less than 7.0 cm per 10 seconds nor greater than 13.5 cm per 10 seconds when determined by a Bostwick Consistometer.

m. Filled, sealed and retorted or hot filled cans shall show evidence of proper vacuum as determined by concavity of the can lid (see 4.5.6).

3.5.1 Palatability. The finished product shall be equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample (see 6.1) in palatability and overall appearance.

3.6 Plant qualification. The product shall be prepared, processed, and packaged in establishments meeting the requirements of Title 21, Code of Federal Regulations, Part 110, "Current Good Manufacturing Practice in Manufacturing, Processing, Packaging or Holding of Human Foods", and the plant sanitation requirements of the appropriate Government inspection agency.

3.7 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Contractor's responsibility. Inspection and acceptance by the USDA shall not relieve the contractor of obligation and responsibility to deliver a product complying with all requirements of this document. The contractor shall assure product compliance prior to submitting the product to the USDA for any inspection.

4.2 Inspection and certification. Product acceptability shall be determined by the USDA. The USDA will determine the degree of inspection necessary to assure compliance with the requirements of this document.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T01:00Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.3 Classification of inspection. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.4).
b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.5).

4.4 First article inspection. When a first article is required (see 6.1, it shall be inspected in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of this document and evaluated for overall appearance and palatability. Any failure to conform to the quality assurance provisions of this document or any appearance of palatability failure shall be cause for rejection of the first article.

4.5 Quality conformance inspection. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.5.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced documents unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this document or other applicable purchase document.

4.5.1.1 Ingredient and component examination. Conformance of ingredients and components to identity, condition, and other requirements specified in 3.2 shall be certified by the ingredient supplier or ingredient manufacturer, and compliance be verified by examination of pertinent labels, markings, U.S. Grade Certificates, certificates of analyses, or other such valid documents acceptable to the inspection agency. If necessary, each ingredient shall be examined organoleptically or inspected according to generally recognized test methods such as the standard methods described in the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists and in the Approved Methods of the American Association of Cereal Chemists, to determine conformance to the requirements. Any nonconformance to an identity, condition, or other requirement shall be cause for rejection of the ingredient or component lot or of any involved product.

4.5.2 In-process examination. In-process examination shall be performed to determine conformance to the preparation, processing, can interior coating, filling, sealing, and packing requirements. Any nonconformance revealed by actual examination or by review or records of time, temperature, and formulation or of other valid documents shall be cause for rejection of the involved product.

4.5.3 Tray pack inspection. The inspection lot shall include only tray packs produced in one workshift. The USDA reserves the right to separate the inspection lot into smaller inspection lots.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T01:00Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.5.3.1 Net weight inspection. Randomly select 30 filled and sealed tray pack cans from the inspection lot and weigh separately. Subtract the average tare weight (determined by randomly selecting and weighing 30 of the empty tray pack cans and lids used in preparing the product and dividing the total weight by 30) from the weight of each tray pack in the sample. The results shall be reported to the nearest 1 ounce. If the average net weight is less than 106 ounces or if the net weight of any individual can is less than 104 ounces, the lot shall be rejected.

4.5.3.2 Product inspection. The thermoprocessed sample can shall be held for a minimum of 72 hours at room temperature (65° to 75°) prior to product inspection. The sample size shall be as indicated by the double sampling plan specified in table I. The tray pack cans shall be selected at random from the lot. The tray pack cans shall be opened and inspected for the defects listed in table II.

TABLE I. Double sampling plan for product inspection 1/

Lot size (cans)	Sample size (cans)	Cumulative sample	Acceptance number	Rejection number
0 to 3,200	8	---	0	2
	8	16	1	2
3,201 to 35,000	13	---	0	3
	13	26	3	4

1/ a. If no defects are found in the first sample, the lot shall be accepted.

b. If the number of defects found in the first sample equals or exceeds the rejection number, the lot shall be rejected.

c. If the number of defects found in the first sample exceeds the acceptance number but is less than the rejection number, the second sample shall be inspected. Defects found in the first and second samples shall be combined and if the number of defects in the cumulative sample equals or exceeds the rejection number, the lot shall be rejected.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T01:00Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE II. Product defects 1/ 2/

Category	Defect
Major	
101	Texture, flavor, odor, and color not characteristic of blueberry dessert.
102	Blueberries hard, fibrous, tough, or mushy.
103	Sauce not glossy or smooth.
104	Product exhibits syneresis (weeps).
105	Sauce is lumpy.
106	Product shows evidence of excessive heating (materially darkened or scorched).

1/ The presence of foreign material (e.g. glass, dirt, insects, insect parts, hair, wood, metal), foreign odor or flavor (e.g. burnt, scorched, moldy, rancid, sour, stale), or foreign color shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

2/ Product not equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample (see 6.1) in palatability or overall appearance shall be cause for rejection of the lot. (This comparison shall be performed only when deemed necessary by the Agricultural Marketing Service (AMS) agent.)

4.5.3.3 pH testing. Three tray packs shall be selected at random from the lot and individually tested for pH in accordance with the applicable chapter for pH determination of the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists. The results shall be reported to the nearest 0.01. Any pH reading is less than 3.2 or greater than 3.8 shall be classified as a major defect and shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.5.3.4 Salt content testing. Nine tray pack cans shall be selected at random from the lot and distributed as follows:

- Three for laboratory analysis
- Three for submission to the contractor
- Three for retention by the AMS agent as a reserve sample

The three tray packs for laboratory analysis shall be individually tested for salt content in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, except that preparation of the samples shall be as follows. The cans shall be opened and the entire contents of each can shall be separately blended in a Waring blender or equivalent. Any individual tray pack can with a salt content less than 0.10 percent or greater than 0.30 percent shall be classified as a major defect and shall be cause for rejection of the lot. Analysis of reserve samples at the request of the contractor shall not be permitted unless the original laboratory analysis

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T01:00Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

indicated that the involved lot will be rejected because of noncompliance with the salt content requirement. When reserve samples are analyzed, the results will be considered final. Unused reserve samples shall be returned to the contractor for inclusion in subsequent lots.

4.5.3.5 Viscosity testing. The strained free liquid sauce collected from each of the cans in the first sample of cans selected for drained weight inspection (see 4.5.3.2 and 3/ to table II) shall be individually tested for viscosity as specified in 4.5.3.5.1 (see 6.4).

4.5.3.5.1 Bostwick Consistometer method.

Instrument: Bostwick Consistometer
Catalog Number: 23270-004
VWR Scientific Company
P.O. Box 7900
San Francisco, CA 94120

or Catalog Number: 15-347-50
Fisher Scientific
585 Alpha Drive
Pittsburg, PA 15238

Method:

a. Level the instrument.

b. Bring sauce to 100°F ± 1°F in a water bath in a covered container.

c. Stir sauce thoroughly before filling the Bostwick cavity.

d. Scrape sauce evenly across upper edge of cavity.

e. Release sauce and time sauce flow to the nearest 1 second and distance traveled to the nearest 0.1 cm.

The lot shall be rejected if the Bostwick viscosity value of the sauce from any can in the sample is less than 7.0 cm per 10 seconds or greater than 13.5 cm per 10 seconds.

4.5.4 Can condition examination. Examination of filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be in accordance with the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers, except that the inspection for labeling shall be in accordance with 4.5.4.1. In addition, the following defect shall be classified as a critical defect and shall be cause for rejection of the lot:

Evidence of buffing causing scratches or scuffing to exterior can coating.

4.5.4.1 Can label examination. Labels shall be examined for defects in accordance with MIL-L-1497 (see 5.4), except, that for self-adhering labels, the following additional defects shall apply:

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T01:00Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Major: Label torn or scratched so as to obliterate any of the markings.

Minor: Air bubbles under label.
Label not properly adhered to can, i.e., label raised or peeled back from edges or corners.

4.5.4.2 Label adhesive examination. When self-adhering labels are used, the adhesive shall be tested in accordance with ASTM D 3330.

4.5.5 Can closure examination. Can closures shall be examined visually and by teardowns in accordance with the can manufacturer's requirement and CFR 21, Part 113, Subpart D, or CFR 9, Part 318, Subpart G, as applicable. Any nonconformance based on observation of can seam teardowns or of record of can seam teardowns is a major defect and shall be cause for rejection of any involved product.

4.5.6 Vacuum examination. Cans shall be allowed to cool to 75° ± 5°F, held for at least 24 hours after sealing; and then examined for vacuum retention. To examine, lay a straight edge in the center of the lid along the length of the tray pack. Both ends of the straight edge shall touch the lid at the inside edge of the double seam. There shall be a visible gap between the straight edge and the lid for the entire distance of the label panel. Using a shorter straight edge, the same procedure shall be used across the width, in the center of the tray pack can. When examining a ribbed lid, only lay the straight edge between the two center ribs along the length of the can. The inspection lot shall include only tray packs produced in a single shift on a single sealing machine. The sample size shall be 50 cans. Any nonconformance shall be classified as a major defect and shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.5.7 Shipping container examination. Shipping containers shall be examined for defects in assembly, closure, and reinforcement (when applicable), in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. In addition, the following defects shall be classified as follows:

Major: National stock number, item description, contract number, or date of pack markings missing, incorrect, or illegible.
Reinforced with other than nonmetallic strapping or tape.
Dimensions of pads not as specified.
Interior packing with fiberboard liner or pads not as specified.

Minor: Other required markings missing, incorrect or illegible.
Arrangement or number of cans not as specified.

4.5.8 Unit load inspection. Inspection of unit loads shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of MIL-L-35078.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation. The product shall be preserved in accordance with level A.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T01:00Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5.1.1 Level A. One hundred and six ounces of food product shall be filled into a tray pack can conforming to MIL-C-44340 and sealed and thermoprocessed as specified in 3.4 and 3.5. Buffing of the can causing damage to the exterior can coating is not permitted (see 4.5.4).

5.2 Packing. The product shall be packed in accordance with level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A packing. Four cans of product, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed and closed in accordance with style RSC-L or HSC-L with a HSC full depth cover, grade V2s of PPP-B-636. The cans shall be packed flat, four in depth within the box, with the first two cans placed with the lids together and the next two cans with the lids together. The inside of each box shall be provided with a box liner and five fiberboard pads fabricated of grade V3c fiberboard. The height of the box liner shall be equal to the full inside depth of the box (+0 inch, -1/8 inch). Flute direction of the box liner shall be vertical. The pads shall be placed between the cans and on the top and bottom of the stacked cans. The pad dimensions shall be not less than 1/8 inch of the full length and width dimensions of the box. Each box shall be reinforced with nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive adhesive filament-reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. Shipping containers shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified (see 6.1) except that the unit load shall consist of 48 boxes with 12 boxes per course and four courses per load with all courses having the same pattern so as to create columnar stacking. When unit loads are strapped, strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping, except for type II, class F loads.

5.2.2 Level B packing. Four cans of product, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed as specified in 5.2.1, except the box shall be constructed of grade V3c, V3s, or V4s fiberboard.

5.2.3 Level C packing. Four cans of product, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed and closed in accordance with style RSC-L, class domestic, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. The cans shall be packed flat, four in depth within the box, with the first two cans placed with the lids together and the next two cans with the lids together. The inside of each box shall be provided with a box liner and five fiberboard pads. The height of the box liner shall be equal to the full inside depth of the box (+0 inch, -1/8 inch). Flute direction of the box liner shall be vertical. The pads shall be placed between the cans and on the top and bottom of the stacked cans. The pad dimensions shall be not less than 1/8 inch of the full length and width dimensions of the box and shall be fabricated of the same material as the box.

5.3 Unit loading. When specified (see 6.1), the product, packed as specified in 5.2.2 or 5.2.3, shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified, except that the unit load shall consist of 48 boxes with 12 boxes per course and four courses per load

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T01:00Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

with all courses having the same pattern so as to create columnar stacking. When unit loads are strapped, the strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping, except for type II, class F loads.

5.4 Labeling. Each tray pack can shall be labeled in accordance with MIL-L-1497 and with the following:

- Official establishment number (e.g., est 38) or a three letter code identifying the establishment.
- Lot number 1/
- Production shift number 1/
- Retort identification number 1/ 2/
- Retort cook number 1/ 2/

1/ The lot number shall be expressed as a four digit Julian code. The first digit shall indicate the year of production and the next three digits shall indicate the day of the year (Example, March 19, 1987 would be coded as 7078). The Julian code shall represent the day the product was packaged and processed. Sub-lotting (when used) shall be represented by an alpha character immediately following the four digit Julian code. Following the four digit Julian code and the alpha character (when used), the other required code information shall be printed in the sequence as listed above.

2/ Required when a retort process is used.

In addition, the name of product shall be marked, stamping is permitted, on one 1001 by 200 side of the can. The labeling shall be legible when examined as specified in 4.5.4 after preparation of product in accordance with heating instructions. Paper labels are not permitted. Cans shall show the following statements:

"Tray cans may be heated prior to serving or served at ambient temperature without heating. When heated, the following heating directions shall apply:

*TO HEAT IN WATER: Submerge unopened can in boiling water. Simmer gently 35 minutes. Avoid overheating (can shows evidence of bulging).

CAUTION: Use care when opening as pressure may have been generated within the can.

TO HEAT IN OVEN: Either punch several holes in lid of can or open can in usual manner leaving the loose lid in place. Place in a 350°F oven 30 - 40 minutes.

WARNING: Do not place unopened can in oven. This may cause the can to burst.

YIELD

For Army Field Feeding, serves 18 portions of 3/4 cup each. For other uses, serves 25 portions of 1/2 cup each."

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T01:00Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

As an alternate labeling method, a preprinted, self-adhering, 0.002-inch thick, clear polyester label printed with indelible black ink may be used. Self-adhering labels shall be applied after retorting. Pressure-sensitive adhesive shall require no preparation prior to application. Labels shall tack quickly and adhere without curling or breaking. The adhesive shall have a minimum adhesion of 60 ounces per inch width when examined as specified in 4.5.4.2. When a self-adhering label is used, the tray pack can shall be labeled with the Julian code and a product code prior to retorting.

5.5 Marking.

5.5.1 Shipping containers. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or purchase order, shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

5.5.2 Unit loads. Unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-L-35078. In addition, the following precautionary marking in capital letters larger than other markings shall be included:

CAUTION: DO NOT STACK PALLETS IN TRANSIT OR MORE THAN TWO HIGH IN STORAGE, UNLESS PALLET RACKS ARE USED.

6. NOTES

(This section contains information of a general or explanatory nature that may be helpful, but is not mandatory.)

6.1 Acquisition requirements. Acquisition documents must specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this document.
b. Issue of DODISS to be cited in the solicitation, and if required, the specific issue of individual documents referenced (see 2.1.1 and 2.2).
c. When a first article is required (see 3.1, 4.4, and 6.3).
d. Provisions for approved preproduction samples (see 3.5.1 and 6.3).
e. Level of packing required (see 5.2).
f. Type and class of unit load when unit loading is required (see 5.2.1 and 5.3).

6.2 Appropriate level of pack. Based on the conditions known or expected to be encountered during shipment, handling, and storage of the specific item being procured, the procuring activity should select the appropriate level of pack in accordance with the criteria established in AR 700-15/NAVSUPINST 4030.28/AFR 71-6/MCO 4030.33A/DLAR 4145.7.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T01:00Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

6.3 First article inspection. When a first article sample is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of FAR 52.209. The first article should be a preproduction sample. The contracting officer should specify the appropriate type of first article and the number of units to be furnished. The contracting officer should also include specific instructions in acquisition documents regarding arrangements for selection, inspection, and approval of the first article.

6.4 Alternative viscosity testing method. The contracting officer may authorize an alternative contractor recommended method of viscosity testing if the alternative method is approved by U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center.

6.5 Subject term (key word) listing.

Canned Dessert
Combat Field Feeding
Operational Ration

6.6 Changes from previous issue. Asterisks are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue due to the extensiveness of the changes.

Custodians:

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 50

Review activities:

Army - MD, TS
Navy - MC
DP - SS

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Project No. 8940-0667

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T01:00Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-B-44256B	Blueberry Dessert, Tray Pack

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION

b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*

4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*

- ☐ VENDOR
- ☐ USER
- ☐ MANUFACTURER
- ☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional

b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional

c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional

8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T01:00Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.